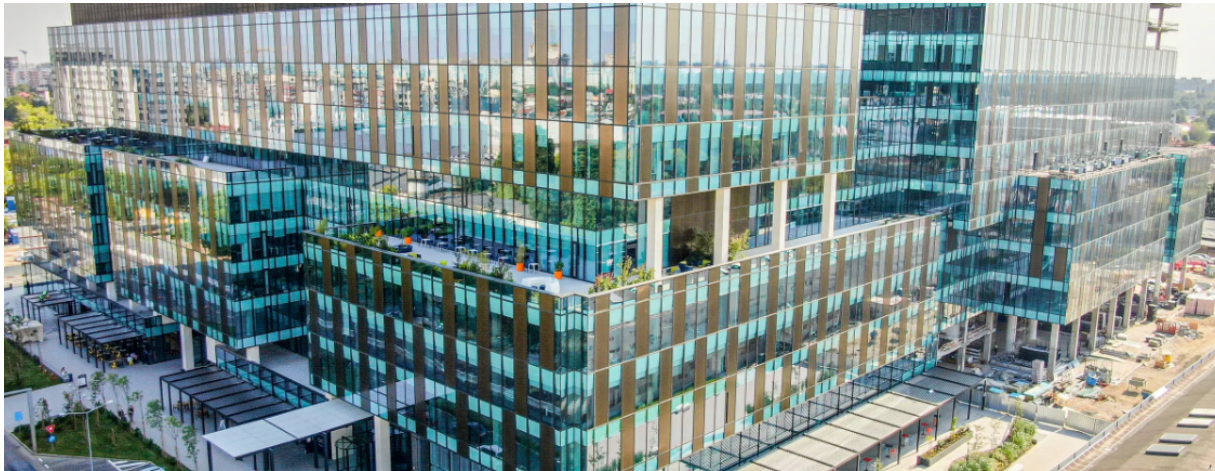


ONE COTROCENI PARK



Why is this project a best practice?

Challenge

The project had to provide high thermal comfort through cold winters and warm summers while sharply reducing operational energy. The main design challenge was to coordinate a high-performance envelope, efficient services, renewable energy and healthy materials without compromising the architectural concept, construction quality or everyday usability.

Solution

The response combines reuse of a 5.8-hectare former industrial site rather than expansion onto undeveloped land; a mixed-use programme combining more than 850 homes with offices, retail and services; and public-transport access, landscaped spaces and integrated infrastructure planned at district scale. These measures were brought together through an integrated design approach and, where applicable, the Green Homes, nZEB or Passive House performance framework.

Replicability

The core package - demand reduction first, airtight construction, efficient low-temperature systems, ventilation and on-site renewables - is transferable to other Romanian homes. Replication requires climate-specific energy modelling, careful thermal-bridge and airtightness detailing, qualified installation, commissioning and clear operating guidance for residents.

Key facts and figures

Location	Former Ventilatorul industrial platform, Cotroceni, Bucharest, Romania
Building use / function	Mixed-use urban regeneration: housing, offices, retail and services
Project type (new build, refurbishment, extension)	Brownfield redevelopment / new build
Plot area / Floor area	Approximately 5.8 ha site; over 850 apartments; more than 250,000 m ² mixed-use development reported by design sources

Year / phase	Green Homes pre-certification; phased delivery
Climate zone	Temperate continental
Thematic focus / innovation	Brownfield regeneration; mixed use; transit access; green community; large-scale energy and mobility integration
Investor / building owner	One United Properties
Architect	X Architecture (publicly identified for the mixed-use project)
Other involved stakeholders	Romania Green Building Council; local authorities; mobility, landscape, office and retail partners
Contact person	One United Properties - https://www.one.ro/
Further information	https://green-homes.org/property/one-cotroceni-park/ https://www.rogbc.org/proiecte-certificate-ro gbc?lang=en https://www.one.ro/en/blog/one-cotroceni-park-obtains-the-green-homes-pre-certification-granted-by-the-romania-green-building-council/

One Cotroceni Park is a brownfield redevelopment / new build project in Former Ventilatorul industrial platform, Cotroceni, Bucharest, Romania. It functions as mixed-use urban regeneration: housing, offices, retail and services. Its main best-practice contribution is One of Bucharest's largest urban-regeneration schemes to use Green Homes pre-certification for its residential component. The documented strategy brings together reuse of a 5.8-hectare former industrial site rather than expansion onto undeveloped land, a mixed-use programme combining more than 850 homes with offices, retail and services, and public-transport access, landscaped spaces and integrated infrastructure planned at district scale. Area and unit figures refer to the wider phased mixed-use project and may evolve by delivery stage. Public-source research was reviewed in July 2026; data that vary by phase are explicitly flagged in this sheet.

What was done differently?

1. Performance concept - Reuse of a 5.8-hectare former industrial site rather than expansion onto undeveloped land.
2. Integrated systems and operation - A mixed-use programme combining more than 850 homes with offices, retail and services.
3. Wider value - Public-transport access, landscaped spaces and integrated infrastructure planned at district scale.

What was achieved?

Impact

Environmental impact: The project reduces energy and associated emissions primarily by lowering demand and then using efficient or renewable systems. Its material, landscape, waste or mobility measures add benefits beyond operational energy where documented. A verified whole-life carbon assessment was not publicly available, so the impact is described qualitatively unless a source provides a specific figure.

Economic impact: Lower energy demand can reduce utility exposure and improve long-term operating-cost predictability. Standardised high-performance specifications and third-party certification can also support quality assurance, market value and access to green-finance products. Public sources do not provide a complete investment, payback or life-cycle-cost analysis for this project.

Social impact: The main social benefits are stable indoor temperatures, better air quality, daylight and acoustic comfort, together with safer and more attractive shared or outdoor spaces where these form part of the project. The project also raises market awareness by making high-performance housing visible to residents, designers, contractors and investors.

Key Learnings

Success factors: Key success factors are an integrated design process, a clear performance framework, early coordination of envelope and building services, selection of competent suppliers, quality control during construction and commissioning. Transparent documentation and communication with occupants are essential to preserve the intended performance in use.

Lessons for replication: Replication should start with an energy and comfort target, not a catalogue of technologies. Design teams should verify thermal bridges, airtightness, ventilation, controls and renewable sizing together; record assumptions by project phase; commission systems; and monitor early operation. Where public figures differ by phase, the final as-built dataset must become the single source of [truth](#).